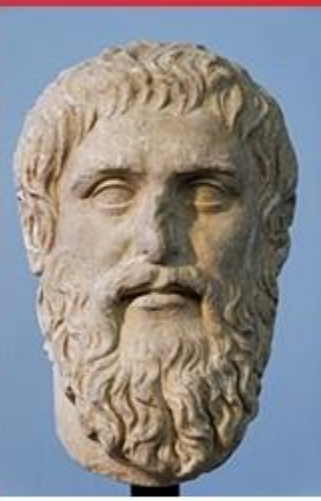
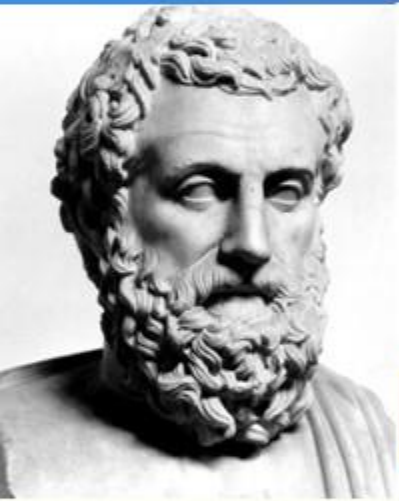


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



MODULE - 4

**ETHICS & HUMAN
INTERFACE**



Religion for ethical principles governs personal life



The business code of ethics governs professional life

Every person's ethics do **not come from the same principles** or are rested on the same source documents.

Hence, there need **not be a consensus** on what is ethically good and ethically bad conduct in a specific situation.

The actions are **shaped by** the fundamental **principles or beliefs** by which that person distinguishes, consciously or unconsciously and instinctively, between morally acceptable and morally unacceptable behavior in that person's eyes.



1 LIFE EXPERIENCES

Most of us **learn** ethics **from our parents** — both from what they teach us in words and more importantly through their own actions.

These **teachings** and **experiences** shape **our** most fundamental **attitudes** about what is "right" and what is "wrong."

A **life-shaping event** or **several significant events** later in life may more directly and consciously shape a person's ethics.

The actions, more than their words, of the parents play a significant role in what their children learn.

SOURCES OF ETHICAL DEVELOPMENT

2 RELIGIOUS BELIEFS



Virtually all the world's religions teach an essentially similar code of ethics that emphasizes honesty, respect for others and their rights, and selflessness.

In both business and personal situations, highly religious persons are likely to act in ways that most of us will regard as highly ethical.

Their religion will give them highly explicit, generally internally consistent, guides to "good" personal conduct. These guidelines usually can be broadened to apply quite well to business activity.

Misinterpreting the tenets of a religion to suit the selfish needs has become a norm among large sections worldwide.

The **second goal** is expressed through specific rules about what those governed by the code definitely must, or must not, do in their dealings with customers, one another, and the public at large.

These self-protective **rules** can sometimes appear to **conflict with** religious, philosophical, or other sources of ethical guidance.

3 CODES OF ETHICS

The most direct sources of our ethical guidance are **codes of ethics**.

These codes generally have **two goals**:

- 1) To **set forth objectives** like quality output, honesty, and public service in the customer or community dealings by the people who are governed by, or choose to subscribe to, a particular code.

- 2) To **protect those to whom the code applies** from harmful conduct by others governed by that particular code — conduct such as unfair competition or actions that cast the entire group in a bad light.



Often the social consensus can become the approved, although unexamined, ethical standard.

The outcome of such discussions depends on the opinions of the participants.

4 DISCUSSIONS WITH OTHERS

Almost daily, even quite casually, virtually all of us **talk about others' and our own actions**—offering frequent opinions about whether what they or we have been doing is good, right, and sensible.

Unless we have strong personal reasons or other commitments to believe otherwise, **most of us tend to "go along" with the opinions of those around us**, rather than "bucking the trend" by independently evaluating the ethical aspects of others' actions

5 ETHICAL DILEMMAS

These dilemmas are **real or imagined** situations that pit two or more ethical principles, rules, or objectives against one another.

To resolve the dilemma, one has to decide which of these ethically desirable ends is the more/most important or, alternatively, if there is a way to achieve both/all of these ends without committing some other ethical wrong.

And the **experiences** drawn **from** such **dilemmas** influences the shaping of our ethical perspective.



Although killing is wrong, would you kill one person in order to save 4 other people?

Dilemma: a difficult situation in which you have to choose between two or more alternatives.



Immanuel Kant

Moral rules should follow two principles:
universality – a moral action is possible to be applied to all people; and
reciprocity – like the Golden Rule.

Remember!

ETHICAL PHILOSOPHERS

the philosophers who have developed systems of ethics—such people as Plato, Aristotle, Kant—have developed **basic principles** from which they have derived systems of ethics.

These principles fall into two general groups: those that are **rules-based** and those that are **results-based**.

Results-based systems of ethics: Kant's **principle of universality**—taking an action only if everyone could take the same action without bringing about more harm than good.

ETHICS COMES FROM



1 Supernaturalism: Teaches that the only source of moral rules is God. Something is good because God says it is, and the way to lead a good life is to do what God wants.

2 Intuitionism: Good and bad are real objective properties that can't be broken down into component parts. Something is good because it's good; its goodness doesn't need justifying or proving.

Intuitionists think that **goodness or badness can be detected by adults** – they say that human beings have an intuitive moral sense that enables them to detect real moral truths.

ETHICS COMES FROM

Consequentialism

'The greatest good for the greatest number of people'.

Non-consequentialism

'The principle of the thing'.

Virtue Ethics

'The way individuals live their lives'.

3 Consequentialism: Teaches that people should do whatever produces the greatest amount of good consequences.

Consequentialism can erroneously lead to the conclusion that some quite dreadful acts are good.

4 Non-consequentialism is concerned with the actions themselves and not with the consequences.

5 Virtue ethics: looks at virtue or moral character, rather than at ethical duties and rules, or the consequences of actions

ETHICS COMES FROM



6 Situation ethics: Rejects prescriptive rules and argues that individual ethical decisions should be made according to the unique situation.

7 Ideology: Some philosophers believe that ethics is the **codification of political ideology**, and that the function of ethics is to state, enforce and preserve particular political beliefs.

They also say that ethics is used by the dominant political elite as a tool to control everyone else.

Power elites enforce an ethical code on other people that helps them control those people, but *do not apply this code to their own behaviour.*

HUMAN ACTIONS



Which action is right?
What is a human action?

How we judge certain actions as good or right whereas others are regarded as bad or wrong?

An attempt to provide an adequate answer to this query requires the analysis of a basic question: What is human action?

It is hence important to separate human actions from their morality.

The type of acts are: Deliberate acts (*actus humanus*) or acts of humans and undeliberate acts (*actus hominis*) or human acts.

Humans are evaluative in nature.

WHAT MAKES IT DELIBERATE?



KNOWLEDGE, ATTENTION AND
JUDGEMENT

There are two essential elements which constitute a human act: **The Intellectual Element** and **The Volitive Element**.

- 1 Intellectual:** The process of knowing entails certain important conditions: (i) **adequate knowledge** of the aspired object, (ii) **attention to the action** by which the particular object is to be pursued and (iii) **judgement on the value** of the act.

With **right effort** the person can have sufficient knowledge of the object and its other considerations which are essential for the making of a human act.

WHAT MAKES IT DELIBERATE?



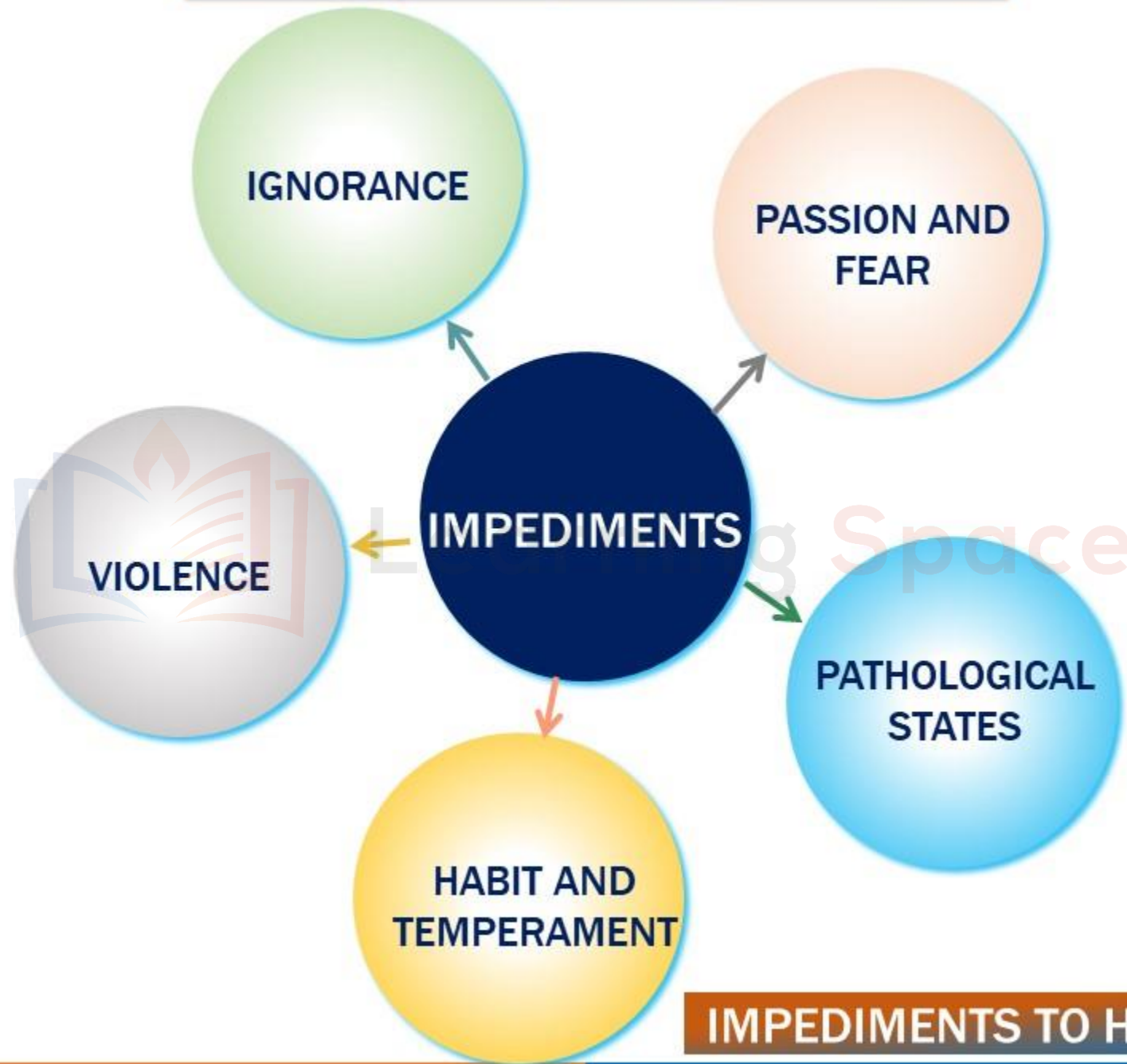
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Volitive: To qualify as a deliberate action, the **action needs to be voluntary**.

Voluntariness or free will is the task of the intellect to **conceptualize the good**, to **propose it to the will** as something desirable, and to **judge the suitability of the means** in its attainment.

If a human person for some valid reason is not free to choose what he/she would like according to his/her insight and will, but has to act against one's will, his/her action is not free and such an act cannot be designated as a human act.

Volitive: of, relating to, or emanating from the will





Ignorance of the law may lead to prosecution and punishment but is open to ethical scrutiny.

1 **Ignorance** is the **absence of knowledge** in a subject capable of having knowledge.

2 **Passions** are **powerful emotions or appetites** springing from a pretense of something perceived as good or evil; they are usually accompanied by bodily changes. Passions include human appetites, such as **anger, grief, love, hatred or greed.**

3 **Violence** can influence the degree to which actions are human or not. Violence is **external physical force exerted** on a person and makes actions done in these circumstances not human actions.



4 **Fear** may influence human action to the extent of rendering it nonhuman, partially or totally human. Fear can be inflicted justly or unjustly and is an emotional reaction arising from an impending danger. Fear may come from sources outside ourselves or from within.

5 **Temperament** may influence Volitive nature. It is the part of your character that affects your moods and the way you behave. Temperament and character may sometimes lessen the voluntariness of actions, but never destroy it.

Fear breeds uncertainty, anger instills confidence.

**HABIT****SCHIZOPHRENIA**

5 Habit is a quality acquired through frequent repetition. Good habits are virtues and bad habits are vices. That a person acquires a habit shows voluntariness at work. But when we acquire habits, our individual actions may become less voluntary because of a lack of attention to a particular action.

6 Pathological States: Insanity, psychosis, schizophrenia and the like may also impact on the voluntariness of human actions. But there is always a question of whether these conditions sufficiently removed human reason to render the action nonhuman.

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